Preliminary Trip Generation Assessment
ZBA2026-0001 / ZA2026-0024 — 9600 2nd Street NW

1. Purpose and Context

This document presents a preliminary trip generation assessment for the proposed Albuquerque Islamic Center conditional use at 9600 2nd Street NW, based on data in the official case record and hearing transcript. It is intended to function as a screening-level analysis, using ITE-style logic and conservative, record-based inputs to answer a single question: whether a formal, engineer-prepared Traffic Impact Analysis (TIA) should have been required and provided before conditional-use approval.

2. Land Use and Size Basis

Land use: The project is a house of worship / mosque with incidental facilities, including a worship hall, gym and basketball court, indoor pool room, commercial kitchen, cafeteria, coffee shop, and offices. This fits within the religious assembly land-use category typically addressed by ITE Trip Generation Manual land-use codes for churches and mosques (e.g., LUC 560–562).

Size basis: The record describes a Board-imposed cap of approximately 60,000 square feet for the high-volume multi-use complex. For preliminary screening, this assessment uses 60,000 square feet of gross floor area (GFA) as the independent variable.

3. Data Inputs from the Record

The assessment relies solely on record-based inputs, including:

• Board-imposed size cap: 60,000 square feet for the High Volume Use Complex.

• Hearing testimony describing worship patterns, split Friday services, parking counts, and operating hours.

• The weekly schedule for the existing Menaul Street mosque entered into the record by the Appellant and undisputed by the Applicant.

• The Appellant’s trip generation exhibit derived from the Applicant’s own attendance figures and weekly schedule, producing a weekly table of record-based trips.

• The 2020 Murphy Express Traffic Study (Packet Pg. 1407–1426) for a site across the street from 9600 2nd St., which projected approximately 86 entering and 83 exiting PM peak-hour trips and reported Level of Service “F” at the Alameda/4th Street signalized intersection (westbound Alameda through-movement) and at the Murphy Express Driveway “A” left-turn movement.

4. ITE-Style Screening Logic

The ITE Trip Generation Manual typically expresses trip rates for religious assembly uses as vehicle trips per 1,000 square feet of GFA or per seat. While the precise rate for a mosque at this location would be obtained from a licensed engineer using the current ITE edition, many jurisdictions and practitioner summaries reference screening ranges on the order of 4–5 peak-hour vehicle trips per 1,000 square feet for comparable worship facilities.

Using that screening band and the 60,000 SF record cap:

• 60,000 SF = 60 units of 1,000 SF.

• Low case: 60 × 4.0 trips/1,000 SF ≈ 240 peak-hour trips.

• Mid case: 60 × 4.5 trips/1,000 SF ≈ 270 peak-hour trips.

• High case: 60 × 5.0 trips/1,000 SF ≈ 300 peak-hour trips.

These values are preliminary screening outputs only. They are not offered as the operative final trip estimate, but as a conservative, cap-based screening using the 60,000 SF approval cap; Exhibit 14 remains the refined, record-based trip analysis and reports 168 PM peak-hour trips (86 entering + 82 exiting) for the revised plan. Even this conservative screening far exceeds the Traffic Impact Study warranting threshold of 100 peak-hour trips.

5. Record-Based Weekly Trip Table

In parallel with the ITE-style floor-area screening, the Appellant prepared a conservative weekly trip table using only the Applicant's own attendance figures, weekly operating schedule, and facility descriptions. The table translates person counts into vehicle trips using a one-vehicle-per-attendee assumption, and explicitly labels recreation and special-gathering components as conservative estimates.

Day	Prayers	Programs	Rec. (est.)	Special (est.)	Staff	Daily Total
Monday	96	24	53	24	20	217
Tuesday	96	20	53	24	20	213
Wednesday	96	0	53	24	20	193
Thursday	96	24	53	24	20	217

Friday	360	87	53	40	20	560
Saturday	96	103	107	60	8	374
Sunday	96	119	107	60	8	390

Weekly totals from this table are: 936 trips from prayers/worship, 377 from programs/Quran, 479 estimated recreation trips, 256 estimated special-gathering trips, 116 staff trips, and a combined weekly total of 2,164+ vehicle trips. Friday alone accounts for approximately 560 trips.

6. Threshold Comparison

Under the Albuquerque/Bernalillo County Development Process Manual (Ch. 7 §7-5(C)(2)) and NMAC §18.31, a formal Traffic Impact Study is warranted when a development generates 100 or more peak-hour trips. Using the screening outputs above, even the low-case estimate of 240 peak-hour trips for the 60,000 SF complex far exceeds that threshold — as does Exhibit 14's refined analysis of 168 PM peak-hour trips.

When the record-based weekly table is viewed alongside this screening band, both independent paths point to substantial demand: an average of approximately 309 daily trips and 560 trips on Fridays, plus a floor-area-based peak-hour range of 240–300 trips. For a mathematician or engineer reviewing these inputs, the direction of bias is conservative because several demand drivers—Eid peaks, regional draw, population transfer from other mosques, and unusual event clustering—are either excluded or only partially reflected.

7. Configuration Summary and Conclusion

Configuration steps: (1) define the land use as a worship complex with incidental facilities; (2) set the size basis at the 60,000 SF cap described in the record; (3) apply an ITE-style peak-hour trip-rate band per 1,000 SF to obtain screening-level trip estimates; and (4) cross-check these results against a record-based weekly trip table built from the Applicant's own attendance and schedule data. Both paths independently screen the project in as a clear TIA case.

Conclusion: Under standard traffic-impact practice, a project whose refined record-based analysis reports 168 PM peak-hour trips (Exhibit 14), whose weekly totals exceed 2,000 trips, and whose corridor the 2020 Murphy Express study already showed operating at Level of Service "F" would ordinarily require a formal, engineer-prepared Traffic Impact Analysis at the conditional-use stage. Deferring the TIA to building permit could refine driveway design, but it could not retroactively supply the substantial evidence needed for the Section 24 finding that this high-volume use will not create undue traffic congestion or hazards.